

Building a culture of Inclusion, Diversity and Equity (IDE): **KPMG in India**



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How important is diversity and inclusion for an organisation and how is KPMG in India, leveraging these aspects?

Inclusion and diversity are both a business and moral imperative that builds trust and compels us to stand up for what is right. Diverse teams are more likely to be innovative and marketable. Also, inclusive work cultures that embrace ethical behaviour, position themselves for success. Our determination is to create the best working environment possible for our colleagues, enabling them to thrive and develop, while furthering our commitment to foster diversity and inclusion at the Firm.

What spurs the I&D goals of the company?

With growing diverse mix of highly talented pool of people, has come our first learning – that

Inclusion, Diversity and Equity (IDE) plans cannot be a 'one-size-fits all'. So, we started our journey with a deep analysis of our current organisational structure through a self-critical lens to identify the weak links and areas that needed immediate attention, followed by customised interventions which are now being monitored for tangible outcomes. It means creating a diverse and inclusive work environment which we believe is everyone's responsibility.

What are the offbeat interventions of KPMG in the I&D space?

Our leaders have enthusiastically taken on reverse mentors from the very large group of millennials to build a bridge and leverage inter-generational living experiences and learnings. Our partner development program will now also include an immersive intervention by external IDE specialists to ensure that we slowly but certainly make this not a topical event but part of our thinking and organisational DNA. We have been industry forerunners in creating an inclusive workplace for our colleagues from the LGBTQI+ community with benefits such as same gender insurance, medical coverage for partners and their parents, gender reassignment surgery and gender-neutral washrooms in our offices.

Striking a balance between the output of an employee and the ledger is vital for a successful company. What is the key to KPMG's sustained success in this aspect?

To be the clear choice for our clients, communities, and people, we have leveraged our value agenda and our purpose statement to evaluate how we operate and how we grow, making talent our top priority, being attuned to the ecosystem we operate in, prioritising learning, steadfast decision-making and leveraging technology where possible.

During the Covid pandemic, how did KPMG's

IDE initiatives fare in keeping the company functional?

In an unpredictable workplace climate, we tried to work with empathy, wisdom, and speed to advance and retain our people. From offering flexible work arrangements, carrying out regular connects and check-ins, using an array of referral strategies, amplifying our wellbeing initiatives to providing advancement opportunities within the Firm by ensuring we promoted our people. We also specifically, reached out to our women colleagues to ensure their wellbeing, given, we understand that most of the caregiving responsibilities in India, still rest with women which accentuates the stress that was already prevailing on account of the lockdowns. One thing that resonated with nearly everyone, including our leaders working from home, is the heightened appreciation of the difficulties of balancing work and family obligations, and therefore the need for increased flexibility on the part of the Firm.

How does KPMG maintain agility in a rapidly changing economic demand and focus with the help of I&D adeptness?

The way we define and talk about the things that make us different, help to bring us together and ensure a strong, inclusive culture in which all our stakeholders have a voice and are heard, feel they belong, and are empowered to contribute. There is an expectation from our clients, our people, and the broader society that we have a robust IDE agenda – linked to the S in ESG agenda. Therefore, embedding IDE priorities in all our HR and business processes is vital. The need to create an environment where everyone feels valued and included will have a positive impact on everything, making a segue into business results, innovation, and decision-making – so that is the premise with which we have operated so far and will continue to do so.